the Neolithic era (c. 6,000 – 2,900 BCE), Greece established various small permanent settlements. Also, it began the domestication of animals and the process of agriculture. The archaeological record at places such as Sesklo, Thessaly and Macedonia in northern Greece suggests that there was an exodus from Anatolia, which can be seen mostly in the distinct styles of pottery that were found in Neolithic Anatolia. Those who lived in northern Greece were the first farmers in the country because this area was much more suited to agriculture than the rest of Greece. Houses here were typically one story high with a single room and a wooden roof.

The Cycladic Civilization (3,200 – 1,100 BCE) developed within the islands located in the Aegean Sea. Various islands including Delos, Paros and Naxos show the first sign of continuous human occupation in this area. At this time, both residential and religious Greek buildings were constructed with stone. The people are known to have relied on trading and fishing to survive. This era is separated into three sub-periods: the Early Cycladic, the Middle Cycladic and the Late Cycladic Period. Through all of these periods, there was a progression in complexity for the arts and the construction of buildings. The Middle Cycladic and the Late Cycladic Periods corresponded with the Minoan period, in which the two finally combined with no recognizable difference.

The Minoan era (2,700 – 1,500 BCE) began on the island of Crete, which is located in the south near the country's borders. The culture that flourished here was named Minoan by the famous archaeologist, Sir Arthur Evans. He discovered the Minoan palace of Knossos at the turn of the 20th century, which was named after the renowned ruler of Crete, King Minos. We do not know what the people here called themselves. What we do know, however, is that the civilization on Crete progressed rapidly.

One of the earliest writing systems was developed on the island of Minoan Crete. Known to the world as Linear A, this language has still not been deciphered. We also know that the people were great ship builders, skilled artists, scientists and formidable fighters. Numerous ancient historians, including Thucydides, name Minos as the first Cretan king to create a naval power that enabled him to conquer and colonize the Cyclades. The